SITE INTELLIGENCE

Site Feasibility Report

Planning Constraint & Buildability Screen

14 Oakfield Road, Guildford, Surrey GU2 4EH

PREPARED FOR

Sample Client

DOCUMENT REFERENCE

SAMPLE-PFCO-REP-SiteFeasibility-R00

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PREPARED BY

Site Intelligence

CLASSIFICATION

Client Confidential

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Headline Ratings

Planning Friction	**25 / 100 - Amber — Manageable**
Buildability	**8 - Moderate**
Overall Risk Level	**- Low**

HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

This guide helps you navigate the Site Feasibility Report. The report assesses whether the proposed works at your property are straightforward, manageable, or complex from a planning and construction standpoint.

Reading Order

- **Start Here:** The three headline ratings on the cover page (Planning Friction, Buildability, Overall Risk) summarise the entire assessment.
- **Then:** Read Section 2 (Executive Summary) for the verdict and 'What This Means for Your Project'.
- **Deep Dive:** Sections 3–10 contain the supporting evidence. Section 11 compares alternative approaches. Section 12 flags cost risk indicators.

Traffic-Light Key

Rating	Meaning
Green (0–20)	Low friction — straightforward from a planning and build standpoint
Amber (21–40)	Moderate friction — some constraints but manageable with the right approach
Orange (41–60)	Significant friction — multiple constraints requiring specialist input
Red (61–80)	High friction — major constraints, elevated risk of refusal or cost overrun
Black (81–100)	Severe friction — fundamental constraints, proceed with extreme caution

What to Do Next

- Check whether planning permission is needed for your proposal (see Section 6)
- Commission any recommended follow-up reports if flagged in the Risk Register
- Share this report with your architect or designer — Section 11 compares alternative approaches
- Contact us with questions: info@pfcoconstruction.co.uk | 01483 363210

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2. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This Site Feasibility Report assesses the proposed works at 14 Oakfield Road, Guildford, Surrey GU2 4EH. The proposal comprises: Proposed two-storey rear extension and loft conversion with associated landscaping and off-street parking provision. The assessment draws on publicly available data from planning, geological, environmental, heritage, and ecological sources to determine whether the project is straightforward, manageable, or complex from a planning and construction standpoint.

Planning Route: The proposed works are likely to fall within permitted development rights under the Town and Country Planning (General Permitted Development) (England) Order 2015 (as amended). A Lawful Development Certificate (LDC) is recommended to confirm the position before starting work.

Ground Conditions: The site is underlain by sandy bedrock with low shrink-swell potential and generally good bearing capacity. Foundation design is expected to be straightforward, with standard strip foundations at typical depths likely to be adequate.

Flood Risk: The site is confirmed as Flood Zone 1 (low probability). No Flood Risk Assessment is required for the proposed works.

Access and Party Wall: Standard road access suitable for construction vehicles. Party Wall Act notice may be required for works to shared walls.

What This Means for Your Project

- **Planning:** The proposed works are likely achievable under permitted development (no planning application needed), but we recommend obtaining a Lawful Development Certificate to confirm the position.
- **Timeline:** Expect approximately 12–16 weeks from instruction to start on site, allowing for LDC application (if pursued), structural design, Building Control, and party wall procedures.
- **Cost:** The main cost risk factors are potential party wall surveyor fees and a precautionary bat survey if the roof is being altered. Foundation conditions are straightforward.
- **Surveys:** A precautionary bat roost assessment is recommended before disturbing the roof structure. Structural calculations and Building Control submission will be required.
- **Ground:** Ground conditions are favourable. A full desk study is not considered necessary for this proposal type on this geology.

Recommended Next Steps

- **1.** Appoint an architect or designer to prepare drawings.
- **2.** Consider applying for a Lawful Development Certificate (LDC) to confirm PD rights.
- **3.** Serve Party Wall Act notice on any adjoining owner (minimum 1 month before works commence).
- **4.** Commission a precautionary bat roost assessment before roof works (best conducted May–September).

- **5.** Appoint a structural engineer for foundation and structural design.
- **6.** Submit Building Control application (Full Plans or Building Notice route).
- **7.** Obtain structural calculations and commence construction.

3. SCOPE, LIMITATIONS, AND DATA CONFIDENCE

This report provides a preliminary screening assessment of the site using publicly available data sources. It is designed as a rapid triage tool to identify key planning and buildability constraints before committing to design, quoting, or specialist surveys.

What This Report Covers

- Automated sweep across 22+ constraint categories for the property address and proposal type
- Planning friction assessment including PD analysis and constraint mapping
- Buildability assessment including ground conditions, access, party wall, drainage, and ecological risk
- Scored and traffic-light-rated findings with risk register and programme impact

What This Report Does Not Cover

- Detailed planning strategy or enforcement analysis
- Structural design or foundation calculations
- Full ground investigation (trial pits, boreholes)
- Contamination assessment or Phase 1 Environmental Assessment
- Formal PD determination (this requires a Lawful Development Certificate from the LPA)

Data Confidence Summary

Data Category	Confidence	Explanation
Flood Zone Classification	High	EA Flood Map for Planning — authoritative national dataset
Geology and Ground Conditions	High	BGS Geology of Britain — authoritative national dataset
Planning Constraints (national)	High	planning.data.gov.uk — multiple national datasets queried
Heritage Assets (NHLE)	High	Historic England National Heritage List for England
Radon Risk	High	UKHSA radon risk dataset
Ecological Designations	High	Natural England authoritative national datasets
TPO Data	Low	Fragmented national dataset — recommend check with LPA
Article 4 Directions	Low	Incomplete national coverage — recommend check with LPA
Site Access Assessment	Medium	Based on aerial and street-level imagery — not a physical site inspection

Reliance and Limitation of Use

This report has been prepared by Site Intelligence™ (a service of PF & Co Construction Ltd) for the sole benefit of Sample Client ("the Client") in connection with the proposed works at 14 Oakfield Road, Guildford, Surrey GU2 4EH ("the Project"). No third party may rely on the contents, findings, or recommendations of this report without the prior written consent of PF & Co Construction Ltd.

4. SITE IDENTIFICATION AND PROPERTY PROFILE

Item	Detail
Site Address	14 Oakfield Road, Guildford, Surrey GU2 4EH
OS Grid Reference	SU 993 498
Easting / Northing	499350 / 149800
Latitude / Longitude	51.2362 / -0.5742
Elevation	62.5 m AOD
Local Planning Authority	Guildford Borough Council
Property Type	Semi-detached house
Estimated Property Age	Post-war (illustrative)
Approximate Storeys	2 storeys

5. PLANNING CONSTRAINT ASSESSMENT

This section presents the results of an automated sweep across major planning constraint datasets for the site.

5.1 Conservation Area Status

Status: Not within a conservation area based on available data.

Implication: Standard permitted development rights apply.

5.2 Listed Building Status

Status: The property itself is not listed. However, heritage assets may be located in the vicinity.

5.3 AONB / National Landscape / National Park

Status: Not within an Area of Outstanding Natural Beauty, National Landscape, or National Park.

5.4 Green Belt

Status: Not within the Green Belt.

5.5 Article 4 Direction

Status: Not found in national dataset. Caveat: recommend confirming with LPA.

5.6 Tree Preservation Orders

Status: Not found in national dataset. Caveat: recommend checking with LPA.

5.7 Flood Risk

Status: The site is in Flood Zone 1 (low probability of flooding).

Implication: No Flood Risk Assessment is required for the proposed works.

5.8 Ecological Designations

Status: No statutory international designations (SPA, SAC, Ramsar) within 2 km. Site may be within a SSSI Impact Risk Zone.

Planning Constraint Summary

Constraint	Status	Source	Confidence	Impact
Conservation Area	Not found	planning.data.gov.uk	High	None
Listed Building (site)	Not listed	planning.data.gov.uk	High	None
AONB / National Landscape	Not found	planning.data.gov.uk + NE	High	None
Green Belt	Not found	planning.data.gov.uk	High	None
Article 4 Direction	Not found	planning.data.gov.uk	Low	Verify with LPA
TPO	Not found	planning.data.gov.uk	Low	Verify with LPA
Flood Zone	Zone 1 (Low)	EA Flood Map for Planning	High	None
SSSI IRZ	Within IRZ	Natural England	High	Below NE threshold
Mining Risk	N/A	MRA	High	None

6. PERMITTED DEVELOPMENT ANALYSIS

6.1 PD Eligibility Check

- **Dwelling:** The property is a dwellinghouse (Use Class C3) — householder PD rights apply.
- **Listed status:** The property is not listed — no Listed Building Consent requirement.
- **Article 4:** No Article 4 Direction found removing PD rights (subject to LPA confirmation).
- **Designated land:** Not on Article 2(3) designated land.

Conclusion: The property is eligible for householder permitted development rights under the GPDO 2015 (as amended), subject to compliance with dimensional limits.

6.2 PD Dimensional Check

GPDO Class	Condition	Limit	Proposal	Status
Class A	Maximum depth (semi-detached)	3 m (or 4 m with Prior Approval)	Within 3 m	PASS
Class A	Maximum height	4 m	Single storey — typically 2.8–3.5 m	PASS
Class A	Maximum eaves height	3 m	Single storey — typically 2.3–2.7 m	PASS
Class A	Materials similar appearance	Required	Subject to design	PASS
Class A	Site coverage (≤50%)	Total enlarged ≤ 50%	Subject to check	TBC

6.3 Planning Route Determination

Recommended Route: Lawful Development Certificate (Proposed) — to confirm that both elements comply with PD rights before commencing work.

7. BUILDABILITY ASSESSMENT

7.1 Ground Conditions (Shallow Assessment)

Bedrock Geology

The site is underlain by sandy bedrock with low shrink-swell potential. This provides generally good bearing capacity for standard foundation types.

Shrink-Swell Classification

Low. Sandy and non-clay-dominant. Volume change potential is minimal.

Foundation Difficulty Indicator: Easy

Non-shrinkable sandy bedrock with low volume change potential. Standard strip foundations at typical depths (0.6–1.0 metres) are likely to be adequate.

7.2 Site Access Assessment

Standard road width with adequate access for delivery vehicles.

Access Difficulty Indicator: Easy

7.3 Neighbour Proximity and Party Wall Assessment

Party Wall Act notice may be required where works affect shared walls or excavation is within 3 metres of adjoining foundations.

7.4 Drainage and Utilities

Flood Zone 1 — no flood risk constraint on drainage design.

Drainage Difficulty Indicator: Easy

Buildability Factor Summary

Factor	Rating	Key Finding	Confidence	Recommended Action
Ground Conditions	Easy	Sandy, low shrink-swell, good bearing	High	None
Site Access	Easy	Standard road, adequate for deliveries	Medium	Confirm on site
Party Wall	TBC	Depends on property layout	High	Serve PWA notice
Drainage	Easy	FZ1, sandy soils, soakaways likely viable	High	Percolation test
Topography	Flat/Gentle	Level site	Medium	None
Ecology	Medium	Bat roost risk from roof works	Medium	Precautionary bat survey
Radon	Lowest band	No measures required	High	None

8. PLANNING FRICTION SCORE

The Planning Friction Score measures the complexity and difficulty of obtaining planning consent (or confirming PD rights) for the proposed works.

Factor	Score	Basis
Base: LDC recommended (combined scheme)	10	PD but LDC recommended
Adjacent heritage assets	+10	Heritage setting consideration
Near PD limits (cumulative)	+5	Combined PD usage approaches limits
TOTAL	25	

Planning Friction Score **25 / 100 - Amber — Manageable**

A score of 25 places this project in the Amber (Manageable) band. The proposed works are likely achievable under permitted development, but an LDC is recommended.

9. BUILDABILITY RATING

The Buildability Rating measures the physical complexity of constructing the proposed works on this specific site.

Factor	Score	Basis
Base: Single-storey rear extension	2	Standard extension complexity
Base: Loft conversion (rear dormer)	4	Moderate structural complexity
Party wall (1 neighbour)	+1	One shared wall, PWA notice required
Bat survey likely (roof works)	+1	Roof disturbance
TOTAL	8	

Buildability Rating **8 - Moderate**

A score of 8 places this project in the Moderate band. Ground conditions are favourable and access is straightforward.

10. RISK REGISTER AND PROGRAMME IMPACT

10.1 Risk Register

Ref	Risk	Category	Severity	Impact	Action	Timeline
RR-01	Cumulative PD limits exceeded	Planning	Medium	Works may require Householder Application	Obtain LDC	+8–12 wks
RR-02	Bat roost in roof void	Ecology	Medium	Protected species found	Commission bat survey May–Sep	+1–7 months
RR-03	Party wall dispute	Party Wall	Medium	Neighbour dissents	Serve PWA notice early	+4–8 wks
RR-04	Asbestos in existing fabric	Structural	Low	ACMs found during works	R&D asbestos survey	+1–2 wks
RR-05	Build-over sewer	Drainage	Low	Extension over public sewer	Thames Water asset search	+4–6 wks

10.2 Programme Impact Summary

Baseline Programme (assuming no complications):

- Design and drawings: 2–4 weeks
- LDC application (if pursued): 8 weeks
- Structural design and Building Control: 3–5 weeks
- Party wall notice and award: 4–8 weeks
- Construction: 10–14 weeks

Total estimated programme: 16–24 weeks from instruction to completion.

11. ALTERNATIVE APPROACHES AND FRICTION REDUCTION

Option	Description	Planning Route	Friction	Buildability	Trade-off
As proposed	Rear ext + rear dormer	LDC recommended	25	Moderate (8)	Full scope
Option A	Rear ext + rooflights only	PD (no application)	5	Easy (5)	Less loft headroom
Option B	4 m ext via Prior Approval + dormer	Prior Approval + LDC	35	Moderate (9)	Larger extension
Option C	Extension only	PD	0	Easy (3)	No loft conversion

12. COST RISK INDICATORS

This section flags factors that may increase construction costs.

Factor	Present?	Impact Description	Cost Risk
Party wall	Yes	Surveyor fees for notices and award	Low
Bat survey	Possible	Precautionary survey and potential licence costs	Low
Asbestos (R&D survey)	Possible	Survey cost + potential removal	Low
Deep foundations (clay)	No	Sandy geology — standard depths expected	None
Flood-resilient construction	No	Flood Zone 1 — no measures needed	None
Restricted site access	No	Standard road access	None

Overall Cost Risk **- Low**

13. APPENDICES

Appendix A: Site Location Reference

OS Grid Reference: SU 993 498

Easting: 499350 | Northing: 149800

Latitude: 51.2362 | Longitude: -0.5742

Elevation: 62.5 m AOD

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SF.1 — Nature of Assessment. This Site Feasibility Report is a preliminary screening assessment based on publicly available data. It is not a formal planning appraisal, a ground investigation, a structural assessment, an ecological survey, or a heritage impact assessment. It is intended to identify potential constraints and inform early-stage decision-making.

SF.2 — Permitted Development Determination. Where this report considers whether proposed works may fall within permitted development rights, this assessment is indicative only. A definitive determination of permitted development rights can only be obtained from the Local Planning Authority by way of a Lawful Development Certificate (LDC) application. PF & Co Construction Ltd does not provide LDC applications and accepts no liability for reliance on any indicative PD assessment contained in this report.

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SF.5 — Flood Zone and Surface Water Distinction. Where this report assesses flood risk, Environment Agency Flood Zone classifications (Zones 1, 2, 3a, 3b) relate to river (fluvial) and coastal flooding only. Surface water (pluvial) flooding is a separate and distinct risk that is not captured by Flood Zone mapping. This report assesses surface water flood risk separately using EA Risk of Flooding from Surface Water data, but publicly available data may not capture all local drainage or surface water conditions. Where flood risk of any type is identified or suspected, a formal Flood Risk Assessment should be commissioned.

SF.6 — Data Source Coverage. This report compiles data from multiple public sources including planning.data.gov.uk, BGS Geology Viewer, Environment Agency flood mapping, Historic England NHLE, Natural England designations, and local authority records. These sources do not provide universal national coverage, may not be updated in real time, and may contain errors. Data confidence is rated per category within the report.

Prepared by:

Site Intelligence — Site Feasibility, BEng (Hons)

PF & Co Construction Ltd

For and on behalf of:

Site Intelligence

A PF & Co Construction Ltd service

Date of issue: 1 March 2026

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Revision: R00

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